



ASHISH KUMAR



QA Automation Lead | Agile & CI/CD Expert

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Professional Summary

Senior QA Automation Engineer with 11+ years of experience across **telecom, networking, and cloud QA**. Proficient in **Python, Java, Robot Framework, Playwright, and CI/CD pipelines (GitLab CI, Grafana, Azure DevOps)**. Experienced in end-to-end test automation, test planning, and quality gates across **API, UI, and microservices layers**.

Proven ability to design **scalable automation frameworks**, drive data-driven testing, and accelerate release cycles with measurable quality gains. Exploring AI-driven test generation, **Dockerized GitLab pipelines, and Azure** automation to enhance scalability and visibility.

Key Achievements:

- Built reusable automation frameworks (Python, Robot Framework, Java) reducing regression cycles by 45 percent and improving feedback loops by 80 percent through optimized CI/CD and shift-left validation.
- Led QA strategy across API, UI, and **performance**, lowering defects by 20% and improving reliability.
- Reduced flaky tests to <1% via stability checks and data-driven design.
- Integrated **Grafana dashboards** into GitLab CI for real-time analytics.
- Skilled in Docker/Kubernetes, JMeter/k6, and REST API testing (**Postman, REST Assured**).

Core Skills:

Python · Java · Robot Framework · Playwright · REST Assured · Selenium/Cypress · PyATS · GitLab CI · Azure DevOps · Grafana · Docker/Kubernetes · JMeter/k6 · API Testing (Postman/Newman) · Test Strategy · Shift-Left · Continuous Testing

Core Competencies & Technical Skills

- **Automation:** Python, Robot Framework, Java, Playwright, REST Assured, Selenium, Postman, PyATS, REST API Automation
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** GitLab CI, Grafana, Azure DevOps, Docker
- **Networking & Wi-Fi QA:** RvR, iperf3, DFS, Roaming, WAN/LAN, Protocols (OSPF, BGP, RIP)
- **Cloud & Virtualization:** AWS, VMware, vSphere, Linux Containers
- **Leadership & Mentoring:** Team guidance, Scrum ceremonies, QA strategy ownership, and cross-functional stakeholder alignment.
- **Performance & Security:** Wireshark, ZAP, Burp Suite, OpenSSL, JMeter
- **QA Practices:** Regression, Functional, Integration, API, and Performance Testing
- **Methodologies:** Agile, Scrum, SAgile, Shift-Left, Test Strategy & Process Optimization

Certifications

Agile & Leadership

- Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I)
- Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I)
- Project Management Professional (PMP) – In Progress

QA & Automation

- Google IT Automation with Python
- Python Bootcamp (Udemy)

Cloud & Security

- Cisco Security Ninja, Advanced White Belt
- Microsoft: Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900) – In Progress
- SmartGrad from Jetking Institute

Education

- 2019 **M.tech- Software Engineering(WASE)**
Birla Institute of Technology And Science, Pilani
- 2014 **Bachelors Computer Applications (BCA)**
New Horizon College, Bengaluru
- 2011 **Pre-university**
New Horizon PU college, Bengaluru
- 2009 **10th (CBSE)**
Kendriya Vidyalaya ASC center, Bengaluru

Work Experience

| QA Engineering Professional | Jun 6, 2022 – Present

Project: Network Surveillance Management Platform (OSS / Service Assurance) | Jun 2022 – Present

- Full-time BT employee leading **end-to-end QA automation, validation, and quality governance** for the **OSS Network Surveillance and Service Assurance ecosystem**.
- Architected a modular automation framework in **Python, Robot Framework, and Java**, integrated with **GitLab CI/CD, Docker, and Grafana** for live execution analytics.
- **Automated UI, API, and microservice** validations using Playwright, REST Assured, and **Postman/Newman**, expanding regression coverage by 40% and enabling parallel execution.
- Designed data-driven test suites covering network topologies, alarms, and performance KPIs across **L2/L3 protocols (ARP, OSPF, BGP)** and Wi-Fi subsystems.
- Introduced shift-left static validation gates and early failure detection, reducing feedback loops from 120 mins → <5 mins and defect leakage by 20%.
- Enhanced visibility and traceability by integrating Grafana dashboards and Prometheus hooks into CI/CD pipelines.
- Functioned as **Scrum Master for a 10-member Agile squad**, ensuring 95% on-time delivery and improved velocity predictability through **sprint retrospectives and backlog refinement**.

Technology Stack: Python, Robot Framework, Playwright, REST Assured, Postman, GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Grafana, Prometheus, AWS, ServiceNow.



| Technical Lead | Mar 8, 2021 – May 27, 2022

Project: Network Surveillance / OSS Service Assurance | Mar 2021 – May 2022

- Served as **QA Delivery Lead** for BT's OSS automation modernization initiative under TCS engagement.
- Designed and implemented **end-to-end automated** regression suites using **Python, Robot Framework, and Playwright** validating microservice-based **telecom** workflows.
- Integrated automation into **GitLab CI/CD**, leveraging AWS cloud environments, **Docker containers, and Grafana** monitoring, boosting pipeline efficiency by 45%.
- Conducted functional, API, and performance testing using **REST Assured, Selenium, and JMeter**, validating system resilience under high-traffic network loads.
- Spearheaded **defect triage, RCA, and test optimization** across multiple releases, lowering production escapes by 20%.
- Authored **test strategy, migration playbooks, and ServiceNow QA documentation**, supporting zero-downtime deployments.
- Coordinated closely with BT product owners, developers, and DevOps teams to align QA metrics with business KPIs, improving overall release confidence.

Technology Stack: Python, Robot Framework, REST Assured, Selenium, JMeter, GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Grafana, Postman, ServiceNow, Agile Jira.



| Senior QA / Test Automation Engineer | Aug 14, 2014 – Mar 3, 2021

- **Ericsson (Dec 2014 – Apr 2016):** Tested **Ericsson SmartEdge Routers and ENM/NMS** systems, automating **L2/L3 protocol suites (OSPF, BGP, RIP)** with **Python and Robot Framework**. Improved test reliability by 25% through modular scripts and VMware-based virtual environments.
- **Cisco (Apr 2016 – Jan 2017):** Automated testing for **TelePresence Management Server (TMS) and Web Security Appliance (WSA)** with **Java, Selenium, and REST Assured**, reducing manual effort by 40%. Conducted end-to-end API, UI, and security testing via **Postman, Burp Suite, and Wireshark**.
- **HBI (Feb 2017 – Dec 2017):** Validated **security administration and access management portals**, performing compliance, vulnerability, and audit testing. Improved detection accuracy by 20%.
- **Capital One (Feb 2018 – Nov 2018):** Executed QA for **AWS cloud migration and data integrity validation**; automated ServiceNow workflows, enabling 30% faster compliance reporting and zero downtime during production cutovers.
- **Cisco (Dec 2018 – Feb 2020):** Developed **PyATS-based automation** for **TelePresence and network provisioning frameworks**, cutting regression cycles by 25%. Integrated test execution into CI pipelines for consistent environment validation.
- **Nokia (Feb 2020 – Mar 2021):** Tested **Network Management Systems (NMS) and API** Management layers using **REST Assured, Postman, and JMeter**. Enhanced reliability and performance metrics by 20% through structured API regression coverage and load testing.

Technology Stack: Python, Java, Robot Framework, REST Assured, Selenium, Postman, JMeter, PyATS, Wireshark, Jenkins, AWS, VMware, Linux Shell.